

English: Understanding Contemporary First Nations, Métis, and Inuit Voices, Grade 11

University Preparation (NBE3U)

College Preparation (NBE3C)

Workplace Preparation (NBE3E)

OVERVIEW

“English: Understanding Contemporary First Nations, Métis, and Inuit Voices” is designed as an alternative to the Grade 11 compulsory courses of the English curriculum. The English curriculum is based on the belief that language learning is essential to responsible and productive citizenship, and that all students can become successful language learners. The curriculum is designed to provide students with the knowledge and skills that they need to achieve this goal. The program helps students develop a range of essential skills in the four interrelated areas of oral communication, reading and literature studies, writing, and media studies, built on a solid foundation of knowledge of the conventions of standard English and incorporating the use of analytical, critical, and metacognitive thinking skills. Students learn best when they are encouraged to consciously monitor their thinking as they learn, and these courses include expectations that call for such reflection.

“English: Understanding Contemporary First Nations, Métis, and Inuit Voices” focuses on these core competencies through exploration of text forms emerging from First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures in Canada, and also of the perspectives and influence of texts that relate to those cultures. The knowledge and skills described in the expectations will enable students to understand, respond to, and appreciate a full range of literary, informational, graphic, oral, media, and cultural texts and to create their own texts in a variety of forms.

Cultural text forms such as clothing and regalia, stories, songs, music, dances, and cultural practices embody social and cultural meanings in relation to their use in contemporary and historical contexts. Exploration of these text forms is therefore a crucial component of “English: Understanding Contemporary First Nations, Métis, and Inuit Voices”. It is critically important that students are taught to engage responsibly with these text forms, as well to follow appropriate cultural protocols to ensure respect for First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures. These protocols vary from nation to nation.

STRANDS

The Grade 11 compulsory courses of the English curriculum are organized in four strands, or broad areas of learning: Oral Communication, Reading and Literature Studies, Writing, and Media Studies. In “English: Understanding Contemporary First Nations, Métis, and Inuit Voices” these four strands are preceded by strand A: First Nations, Métis, and Inuit Perspectives and Text Forms in Canada. Although strand A is presented separately from the areas of learning presented in strands B–E, in practice students constantly apply the knowledge and approaches included in strand A as they work to achieve the expectations in all areas of learning.

The knowledge and skills described in strands B–E are interdependent and complementary. Teachers plan activities that blend expectations from the strands in order to provide students with the kinds of experiences that promote meaningful learning and that help them recognize how literacy skills in the four areas reinforce and strengthen one another.

A. First Nations, Métis, and Inuit Perspectives and Text Forms in Canada

Identities, relationships, and self-determination, sovereignty, and self-governance are key concepts in First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures. As students explore texts emerging from and/or related to diverse Indigenous cultures, they learn to identify and analyse these concepts, formulating questions and comparing perspectives to stimulate a well-reasoned exchange of ideas. Through reading, listening, discussing, and writing about text forms in Canada, students also deepen their understanding of how textual representations of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals, communities, and cultures are influenced by perspectives related to or shaped by historical period, cultural background, and social and political conditions and events, including perspectives related to gender and the role of women.

It is critically important that students learn to appreciate the responsibility that the creators of text forms in Canada have to affirm and acknowledge First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, world views, and diversity through authentic and complete representations of Indigenous lives.

B. Oral Communication

Oral language is a fundamental means of communication with others and the cornerstone of learning in all areas. Through talk, students not only communicate information but also explore and come to understand ideas and concepts; identify and solve problems; organize their experience and knowledge; and express and clarify their thoughts, feelings, and opinions. When they converse about information and ideas, they become aware not only of the various perspectives of other speakers and writers but also of the language structures and conventions they use. As students work towards achieving the expectations for this strand, they will improve their ability to explore and communicate ideas in both classroom and formal speaking situations.

To develop their oral communication skills, students need numerous opportunities to listen and to talk about a range of subjects, including personal interests, cultural knowledge, school work, and current affairs. Students should be provided with opportunities to engage in various thought-provoking oral activities in connection with expectations in all the strands – for example, brainstorming to identify what they know about the topic of a new text they are about to read, discussing strategies for solving a problem in a writing

assignment, presenting and defending ideas or debating issues, and offering informal critiques of work produced by their peers.

As students explore various text forms associated with the oral traditions of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, they learn how to select and use culturally appropriate listening practices to further their understanding of the lessons and knowledge to be gained from traditional stories, including historical knowledge. They also gain insight into the social, economic, and political forces that affect the transmission of stories, as well as the significance of these stories not only to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities but also to Canadian society as a whole.

It is important for students to develop an understanding that some knowledge is sacred and may be shared only with permission and/or in certain situations. As a result, recording or reproducing an oral teaching, a story, or a song may require explicit permission from the knowledge holder and/or community.

Listening and speaking are essential skills for social interaction at home, at school, and in the community. In order for all students to benefit from the opportunities provided in the classroom for listening and speaking, differences in the norms and conventions associated with oral communication in different cultures must be taken into account. In addition, for some students, the notion that learning involves talk is unfamiliar, and talk that supports learning must be explicitly taught and modelled. All students can benefit from opportunities to improve their listening and response skills and to refine their ideas and their ability to express them.

The Oral Communication strand focuses on the identification and development of the skills and strategies effective listeners and speakers use to understand and interact with others. It also emphasizes the use of higher-order thinking skills to stimulate students' interest and engage them in their own learning.

C. Reading and Literature Studies

"English: Understanding Contemporary First Nations, Métis, and Inuit Voices" focuses on developing the knowledge and skills that will enable students to become effective readers. An effective reader is one who not only grasps the ideas communicated in a text but is able to apply them in new contexts. To do this, the reader must be able to think clearly, creatively, and critically about the ideas and information encountered in texts in order to understand, analyse, and absorb them and to recognize their relevance in other contexts. Students can develop the skills necessary to become effective readers by applying a range of comprehension strategies as they read and by reading a wide variety of texts from First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and, as appropriate, relevant texts from non-Indigenous sources. It is also important that they read a range of materials that illustrate the many uses of writing. By reading widely, students will develop a richer vocabulary and become more attuned to the conventions of written language. Reading various kinds of texts in all areas of the curriculum will also help students to discover what interests them most and to pursue and develop their interests and abilities.

Reading is a complex process that involves the application of various strategies before, during, and after reading. For example, before reading, students might prepare by identifying the purpose of the reading activity and by activating their prior knowledge about the topic of the text. Teachers help build the necessary background knowledge for students

whose life experiences may not have provided them with the information they need to understand the text. During reading, students may use “cueing systems” – that is, clues from context or from their understanding of language structures and/or letter-sound relationships – to help them solve unfamiliar words, and comprehension strategies to help them make meaning of the text. Comprehension strategies include predicting, visualizing, questioning, drawing inferences, identifying main ideas, summarizing, and monitoring and revising comprehension. After reading, students may analyse, synthesize, make connections, evaluate, and use other critical and creative thinking skills to achieve a deeper understanding of the material they have read. It is essential that teachers provide adequate time for students to apply various strategies before, during, and after reading not only in order to develop reading skills but also to ensure that there is an opportunity to support students who may find some texts emotionally difficult due to their own experiences and connections to the material.

Teachers must use their professional judgement in deciding which comprehension strategies to model and teach, based on the identified learning needs of the students in their classrooms and on the nature of the particular texts students are reading.

Fluent, independent readers read frequently for a variety of different purposes – to locate information, to satisfy curiosity, for enjoyment, to build vocabulary, for research, and for various more specifically defined purposes. The purpose for reading will be determined by the teacher in some cases and by the student in others. The reading program should include a wide variety of literary, informational, and graphic texts that engage students’ interest and imagination – for example, novels; poetry; short stories; textbooks and books on topics in science, history, mathematics, geography, and other subjects; biographies, autobiographies, memoirs, and journals; plays and radio, film, or television scripts; encyclopaedia entries; graphs, charts, and diagrams in textbooks or magazines; instructions and manuals; graphic novels, comic books, and cartoons; newspaper and magazine articles and editorials; databases and websites; and essays and reports. Teachers should routinely provide materials that reflect the diversity of Indigenous peoples. Frequent exposure to good writing will inspire students to work towards high standards in their own writing and will help them develop an appreciation for the power and beauty of the written word.

This strand helps students learn to read with understanding, to read critically, to become familiar with various text forms and their characteristic elements, and to recognize the function and effects of various text features and stylistic devices. It helps students understand that reading is a process of constructing meaning and equips them with the strategies that good readers use to understand and appreciate what they read.

D. Writing

A central goal of the Writing strand is to promote students’ growth as confident writers and researchers who can communicate competently using a range of forms and styles to suit specific purposes and audiences and correctly applying the conventions of language – grammar, usage, spelling, and punctuation. These conventions are best learned in the context of meaningful and creative writing activities that allow students to develop the ability to think and write clearly and effectively on subject matter related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures.

Writing, from initial musings to final publication, is a complex process that involves a range of complementary thinking and composing skills, as well as other language processes,

including reading, speaking, and listening. As writers compose, they consider their audience; make decisions about form, style, and organization; and apply their knowledge of language use. To develop these competencies, students need a supportive classroom environment, with opportunities to extend and refine their skills in using the writing process and doing research. Students need opportunities to apply these skills and to write daily, in many forms and genres, for a variety of purposes and audiences, and within different time constraints. The forms and genres explored may include essays, reports, short stories, poetry, scripts, journals, letters, biographies, children's stories, articles, blog posts, reviews, précis, explanations, instructions, notes, procedures, and advertisements. Because post-secondary institutions and employers require clear, well-organized writing, on demand and within strict timelines, students also need to learn and practise strategies for writing effectively and correctly in the context of in-class writing assignments and test situations.

Students benefit from opportunities to produce writing that is interesting and original and that reflects their capacity for independent critical thought on subject matter related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures. Writing activities that students find meaningful and that challenge them to think creatively about topics and concerns that interest them will lead to a fuller and more lasting command of the essential skills of writing.

Writing on subject matter related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures needs to be approached sensitively. Students learn to take into account the responsibility to ensure that their work is free from bias, stereotypes, misinformation, and cultural appropriation.

The overall expectations in this strand focus on the elements of effective writing (ideas/content, organization, voice, word choice, sentence fluency, language conventions, and presentation) and on the stages of the recursive writing process (planning for writing, drafting, revising, editing and proofreading, and publishing). In the specific expectations, the examples and sample questions refer to writing forms and language conventions that are appropriate for instruction in the given course. The forms and conventions noted are not, however, the only ones that may be taught in the course. Teachers will continue to use their professional judgement to decide on the forms and conventions students will study, based on the identified learning needs of the students in their classrooms.

E. Media Studies

The Media Studies strand focuses on the art, meaning, and messaging of various forms of media texts emerging from First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and, as appropriate, relevant media texts from non-Indigenous sources. Media texts can be understood to include any work, object, or event that communicates meaning to an audience. Most media texts use words, graphics, sounds, and/or images, in print, oral, visual, or electronic form, to communicate information and ideas to their audience. Whereas traditional English language study may be seen to focus primarily on the understanding of the word, media studies focuses on the construction of meaning through the combination of several media "languages" – images, sounds, graphics, and words.

Media studies explores the impact and influence of mass media and popular culture by examining texts such as films, songs, video games, action figures, advertisements, music advertising media, clothing, billboards, television and streaming content, magazines, newspapers, photographs, and websites. These texts abound in our electronic information age, and the messages they convey, both overt and implied, can have a significant influence on students' lives. For this reason, critical thinking as it applies to media products

and messages assumes a special significance. Understanding how media texts are constructed and why they are produced enables students to respond to them intelligently and responsibly. Students must be able to differentiate between fact and opinion; evaluate the credibility of sources; recognize bias; be attuned to discriminatory portrayals of individuals and groups, such as Indigenous peoples, religious or sexual minorities, people with disabilities, or seniors; and question depictions of violence and crime.

Students' repertoire of communication skills should include the ability to critically interpret the messages they receive through the various media and to use these media to communicate their own ideas effectively as well. Skills related to media such as the Internet, film, and television are particularly important because of the power and pervasive influence these media wield in our lives and in society. Becoming conversant with these and other media can greatly expand the range of information sources available to students, and enhance potential career opportunities in the communication and entertainment industries.

To develop their media literacy skills, students should have opportunities to view, analyse, and discuss a wide variety of media texts from First Nations, Métis, and Inuit sources, and, as appropriate, relevant media texts from non-Indigenous sources and relate them to their own experience and/or understanding. They should also have opportunities to use available technologies to create media texts of different types (e.g., computer graphics, cartoons, graphic designs and layouts, podcasts, short videos, blogs, web pages).

This strand focuses on helping students develop the skills required to understand, create, and critically interpret media texts. It examines how images (both moving and still), sound, and words are used, independently and in combination, to create meaning. It explores the use and significance of particular conventions and techniques in the media and considers the roles of the viewer and the producer in constructing meaning in media texts. Students apply the knowledge and skills gained through analysis of media texts as they create their own texts on subject matter related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures.

In the specific expectations in this strand, the examples and sample questions refer to media forms and conventions that are appropriate for instruction in the given course. These are not, however, the only forms and conventions that students may explore in the course. Teachers will continue to use their professional judgement to decide on the forms and conventions students will study, based on the identified learning needs of the students in their classrooms.

THE RESEARCH AND INQUIRY PROCESS

Educators are encouraged to refer to the general discussion of the research and inquiry process that appears in the introduction to this document (see page 24) for necessary information relating to all First Nations, Métis, and Inuit studies courses. Inquiry and research are at the heart of learning in “English: Understanding Contemporary First Nations, Métis, and Inuit Voices”. They are incorporated into all the strands as students locate, question, and validate information through a rigorous process of interpretation and reflection in oral communication, reading, writing, and media studies. Students develop their ability to ask questions more deeply or thoughtfully and to explore a variety of possible answers to those questions.

English: Understanding Contemporary First Nations, Métis, and Inuit Voices, Grade 11

College Preparation

NBE3C

This course explores the themes, forms, and stylistic elements of literary, informational, graphic, oral, cultural, and media text forms emerging from First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures in Canada, and also looks at the perspectives and influences of texts that relate to those cultures. In order to understand contemporary text forms and their themes of identity, relationship, and self-determination, sovereignty, or self-governance, students will study the use of text forms by Indigenous authors/creators from other periods in expressing ideas related to these themes. Students will also create oral, written, and media texts to explore their own ideas and understanding, focusing on the development of literacy, communication, and critical and creative thinking skills necessary for success in academic and daily life. The course is intended to prepare students for the compulsory Grade 12 English college preparation course.

Prerequisite: English, Grade 10, Academic or Applied

A. FIRST NATIONS, MÉTIS, AND INUIT PERSPECTIVES AND TEXT FORMS IN CANADA

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

Throughout this course, students will:

- A1. Exploring:** explore themes related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit identities, relationships, and self-determination, sovereignty, or self-governance, as reflected in text forms created in Canada, formulating questions and comparing perspectives to stimulate a well-reasoned exchange of ideas about these topics;
- A2. Deconstructing:** demonstrate an understanding of how representations of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals, communities, and cultures in text forms created in Canada are influenced by perspectives related to or shaped by historical period, cultural background, and social and political conditions and events, including perspectives related to gender and the role of women;
- A3. Reconstructing:** demonstrate an understanding of the role of contemporary and historical text forms created in Canada in representing the diversity of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit lives, cultures, and world views, and assess the impact on Canadian society of efforts to challenge colonialist views and incomplete or inaccurate representations.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

A1. Exploring

Throughout this course, students will:

Identifying Text Forms

- A1.1** identify various cultural text forms* and associated customs from First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and explain how they support the communication of meaning within the society (e.g., *Anishinaabe pictographs painted on rocks communicate visions and messages through images of humans and animals; a traditional talking stick is a means to facilitate discussion at various circles, ceremonies, and cultural events through the use of symbolism and honoured protocols; clothing or regalia created to be worn at First Nations powwows and other cultural gatherings reflects identity and collective values; the Haudenosaunee Thanksgiving Address is said before all else at ceremonies and significant meetings to give thanks for the natural world*)

Sample questions: “How does the Hiawatha Belt record the development of the Five Nations Confederacy? What are the teachings behind its symbolism? How do the oral stories that accompany the belt help the beneficiary understand the Great Law of Peace?”

Formulating Questions

- A1.2** formulate appropriate questions to guide their explorations of themes, ideas, and issues related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit identities, relationships, and self-determination, sovereignty, or self-governance, as reflected in various Indigenous text forms, and, as appropriate, in relevant non-Indigenous texts (e.g., factual question: “How are the designations ‘status’ and ‘non-status’ determined?”; comparative question: “What are some similarities and differences in the expression of cultural identity by Métis and Inuit individuals?”; causal question: “What are some consequences of presenting a

* The term “cultural text form” is used in this document to refer to forms and means of communication – including, for example, elements of material culture, such as clothing and regalia; stories; songs, music, dances; and cultural practices – that have developed over time on the basis of the beliefs and values of the culture and that are respected, honoured, and passed on from generation to generation to express and communicate those shared beliefs and values. These forms employ various symbols, practices, images, sounds, and/or concrete forms to convey information and ideas. See [page 188](#) for background information and a chart identifying various types of cultural text forms.

decolonizing perspective in contemporary informational narratives about Canada?”)

Sample questions: “What is an inquiry stance? How does using an inquiry stance help you understand the divergence of views presented in these two texts?”

Exploring Identities

A1.3 identify and describe several different themes, ideas, and issues related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit identities, as reflected in various Indigenous text forms, and, as appropriate, in relevant non-Indigenous texts (*e.g., with reference to the challenge of reconciling multiple cultural identities, self-identification and naming, a sense of isolation and marginalization*)

Sample questions: “As you reflect on a local First Nation gathering that you attended, what aspects of the experience did you find personally meaningful? What did you learn about individual or cultural identity? How did you make meaning of the cultural text forms that were present?”

Exploring Relationships

A1.4 identify and describe several different themes, ideas, and issues associated with relationships in First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, as reflected in various Indigenous text forms, and, as appropriate, in relevant non-Indigenous texts (*e.g., with reference to the ways in which natural law shapes the relationship between humanity and nature in many Indigenous cultures, the relationship between community aspirations and individual aspirations*)

Sample questions: “How is the concept of relationships expressed in various treaties? Why is it important to explore how nation-to-nation relationships are reflected not only in written text forms such as treaties but also in cultural text forms such as wampum belts?”

Exploring Self-Determination, Sovereignty, and Self-Governance

A1.5 identify and describe several different themes, ideas, and issues related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit self-determination, sovereignty, or self-governance, as reflected in various Indigenous text forms, and, as appropriate, in relevant non-Indigenous texts (*e.g., with reference to traditional territories; international, national, and provincial political leadership; Métis governance structures and community charter membership; grassroots civic action*)

Sample question: “Why do you think the author of this article took time to tell the story of the geography of this territory and

its importance to the first peoples before making his or her main point about sovereignty or self-governance?”

Comparing Perspectives

A1.6 compare several different perspectives on themes, ideas, and issues related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit identities, relationships, and self-determination, sovereignty, or self-governance, as reflected in various texts from both Indigenous and non-Indigenous sources (*e.g., compare the perspectives on the role of humanity within the natural environment expressed in a text by a First Nation, Métis, or Inuit writer and one by a non-Indigenous Canadian writer; after reviewing several different texts, define the concept of community from a First Nations, Métis, or Inuit perspective and identify various similarities and differences with a non-Indigenous perspective*)

Sample questions: “How might the perspective of a magazine article on the history and contemporary context of Inuit in Canada vary depending on the sources it is drawn from?” “How would you outline the perspectives of these two news articles about the role of Indigenous men and fathers today?” “What are some of the similarities and differences between the way these two short stories approach the theme of a family’s connection to the urban Indigenous community?”

A2. Deconstructing

Throughout this course, students will:

Viewpoint

A2.1 determine how the messages relating to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures conveyed in various contemporary and historical Indigenous text forms, and, as appropriate, in non-Indigenous texts, might change if they were presented from different perspectives (*e.g., the perspectives of veterans, landowners, non-Indigenous immigrants, elderly community members, First Nations women, individuals who live off the land*), and make inferences about how the viewpoint of the creator/author is shaped by factors related to historical period, gender, culture, sexual orientation, ability, and/or politics

Sample questions: “What cultural factors do you think are shaping the perspective presented in this news article? On what evidence do you base your opinion?” “From whose perspective is this article about fishing, hunting, and gathering written? How might the article differ if it

had been written from the perspective of a First Nation hunter or fisher?" "Whose perspective is reflected in this non-Indigenous historical account of the fur trade? How might the account change if it were written from the perspective of a First Nation, Métis, or Inuk woman?"

Contradictions

A2.2 identify contradictions in how First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures have been depicted in various contemporary and historical Indigenous text forms, and non-Indigenous texts (e.g., *militant versus peaceful, stewards of the land versus territorially acquisitive*), and analyse possible reasons for the divergence of views

Sample questions: "What are some different perspectives on current treaty relations presented in contemporary texts? What reason can you offer for any contradictions in those perspectives?" "How did listening to a First Nation treaty researcher talk about treaty relations and nationhood change your view of treaties in Ontario? What elements of the talk contradicted your earlier understanding of treaties?" "In some European historical accounts of encounters between First Nations peoples and European settlers, First Nations individuals are depicted as inherently gentle and in other accounts as inherently violent. How can you explain this contradiction?"

Positioning

A2.3 make inferences about attitudes towards First Nations, Métis, and Inuit content in various contemporary and historical text forms, providing explanations that draw on appropriate evidence to support their opinions (e.g., *the juxtaposition of ideas; the context within which traditional knowledge is presented; the application of Western academic criteria to First Nations, Métis, or Inuit knowledge sources*)

Sample question: "How might your interpretation of the Anishinaabe Ojibwe creation story have changed if the story had been presented in the context of diverse belief systems, rather than as a myth?"

Accessibility

A2.4 describe various contemporary and historical factors affecting public access to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit text forms, including cultural text forms (e.g., *the ability of publishers in Canada to widen or restrict the audience for texts by First Nations, Métis, and Inuit creators/authors; the development of Indigenous publishers and book-sellers with a commitment to promote, preserve, and publish First Nations, Métis, and Inuit stories and knowledge; the protection of cultural text forms by First Nations, Métis, and Inuit societies*)

Sample questions: "Why do certain First Nations, Métis, and Inuit societies protect the publication of cultural text forms containing traditional knowledge? What is the significance of this protection to the represented cultures? What are some similar practices in your own culture or others around the world?"

Asymmetries

A2.5 describe various issues related to attempts to apply Western cultural criteria to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit text forms, including cultural text forms (e.g., *the privileging of finite knowledge over evolving and contextual knowledge, the undervaluation of communal knowledge banks in favour of individual intellectual property*)

Sample question: "How do copyright requirements challenge First Nations, Métis, and Inuit beliefs about knowledge and knowledge transfer?"

A3. Reconstructing

Throughout this course, students will:

Acknowledging

A3.1 demonstrate an understanding of several different challenges First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals and communities face and have faced in controlling their own narratives and resisting colonialist views, as revealed in text forms studied in this course (e.g., *describe various factors that impeded the ability of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit creators/authors to find mainstream audiences for their work during the movement towards self-determination in the mid-twentieth century; identify some examples of appropriation of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultural production*)

Sample questions: "What are some themes that contemporary First Nations, Métis, and Inuit authors are exploring as a way to challenge and change the legacy of colonialism through new narratives?" "Who is the target audience for contemporary First Nations, Métis, and Inuit literature? Has that audience changed since the mid-twentieth century? In what ways?"

Naming

A3.2 identify appropriate ways to refer to Indigenous peoples in various contexts (e.g., *in the text of treaties, in land claim agreements, in descriptions of courses within a First Nations, Métis, and Inuit studies program*), and locate examples of inappropriate terminology in contemporary and historical text forms from both Indigenous and non-Indigenous sources

Sample questions: “Why might the terms ‘First Nations’, ‘Métis’, and ‘Inuit,’ or ‘Indigenous’ be more appropriate than ‘Native’ or ‘Aboriginal’ in a Canadian context?” “Why might the term ‘band’ be inappropriate to use in reference to Métis communities?” “What are some of the connotations of terms used in historical novels to refer to First Nations, Métis, or Inuit individuals?”

Diversity

A3.3 describe several different ways in which the diversity of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit lives, knowledge, cultures, and world views is represented or under-represented in contemporary and historical text forms (*e.g., compare texts from different historical periods to determine how the imagery in each text either romanticizes Indigenous peoples or accurately reflects the diversity of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and construct a timeline to show the changing use of images and symbols; locate an example of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit world views being depicted as a single world view in a contemporary film or a book they are reading in class; describe various different world views represented in written descriptions of courses offered in a First Nations, Métis, and Inuit studies program*)

Sample questions: “What are some ways in which First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals and communities are referred to in historical informational texts such as newspapers and treaties? What does that reflect about colonial views of Indigenous diversity?” “How does the author of this municipal history represent the role of diverse First Nations in the development of the town? In your opinion, is this representation accurate? Why, or why not?”

Relevance

A3.4 evaluate a variety of contemporary text forms to determine how accurately they represent the lives and activities of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals and communities, past and present (*e.g., explain how the images in a multimedia text reinforce or undermine the message that First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities are contemporary and vibrant*), and describe several different ways in which updated representations can influence society (*e.g., contemporary text forms such as video blogs enable First Nations, Métis, and Inuit youth to express personal perspectives and find common ground with non-Indigenous youth; increasing the presence of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit journalists helps national news programs to better represent contemporary life in Canada*)

Sample questions: “Which type of text has most affected your ideas about First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures: literature, informational texts, or media texts? Why?” “What images in the text reinforced or dispelled the notion that Indigenous peoples are peoples of the past?” “In what ways does the use of a contemporary text form, such as a video blog, to express First Nations, Métis, and Inuit perspectives encourage intercultural connections and understanding?”

Affirmation

A3.5 describe several different contemporary efforts to affirm the value and counteract the undervaluation of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultural text forms (*e.g., as reflections of the interconnectedness of cultural and spiritual identity rather than distinct and separate expressions of culture or spirituality*), and analyse some of the ways in which these efforts have influenced society

Sample questions: “What are some cultural text forms that contemporary First Nations, Métis, and Inuit writers draw on to change non-Indigenous perceptions of the contemporary lives of Indigenous peoples?” “What are some ways in which Indigenous scholars are using cultural text forms to share First Nations, Métis, and Inuit perspectives on child care and custody in Canada?” “How has the use of talking circles changed the approach of courts of law to family mediation?”

B. ORAL COMMUNICATION

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1. The Oral Tradition:** demonstrate an understanding of text forms, figures, and practices associated with the oral traditions of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, explaining how these traditions communicate meaning and how they are used in contemporary communities, and demonstrate the use of culturally appropriate listening practices;
- B2. Listening to Understand:** listen to oral texts from and/or related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures in order to understand and respond appropriately in a variety of situations for a variety of purposes;
- B3. Speaking to Communicate:** use speaking skills and strategies appropriately to communicate with different audiences, for a variety of purposes, about themes, ideas, and issues related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures;
- B4. Reflecting on Skills and Strategies:** reflect on and identify their strengths as listeners and speakers, areas for improvement, and the strategies they found most helpful in oral communication contexts related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

B1. The Oral Tradition

By the end of this course, students will:

Oral Text Forms and Their Use

- B1.1** identify various text forms associated with the oral traditions of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures; explain their purpose and symbolic meaning (*e.g., welcoming addresses, oral stories, affirmations, and songs acknowledge past, present, and future creation and provide the context for various gatherings; the Haudenosaunee Great Law connects the past to current and future ways of life by providing an in-depth reiteration of history*); and describe several different customs governing their use (*e.g., youth are encouraged to participate in ceremonies and offer welcoming addresses to ensure that cultural protocols and Indigenous languages are sustained; welcoming songs are sung as women give birth to accept the baby into the community*)

Sample questions: “What important information do the Tlingit people convey through song? Why do you think it might be challenging in contemporary society to settle a dispute by gifting a song? What conditions must be present for such a peace-making strategy to work?”
 “What does the relationship between pipe and pipe carrier in many First Nations cultures

imply about the beliefs and perspectives of the culture with respect to communicating something of importance? How is the pipe carrier role connected to oral tradition? What might be an equivalent relationship and/or oral cultural text form in contemporary society?”

Figures and Their Function

- B1.2** describe a variety of significant figures from First Nations, Métis, and Inuit oral stories (*e.g., Grandfather Sun, Kuikuhâchâu or Wolverine, Great Spirit or Creator, Mother Earth, Weesageechak, Coyote, the Three Sisters*), including their origins, roles, characteristics, and behaviour, and explain how they reflect a particular culture’s world view (*e.g., spirit helpers known by the Métis as Ma-ma-kwa-se-sak or the “Little People” come to the aid of those in need, demonstrating the close connection between the human and spiritual worlds*)

Sample questions: “How does the trickster in Cree oral stories compare to the trickster in Mi’kmaq stories? In what ways do the teachings of the characters from these two traditions differ? In what ways are they the same? How do their actions explain elements of nature?”
 “What differences or similarities can you identify in the Raven of Inuit and West Coast Salish oral traditions?”

Societal Influences

B1.3 explain the influence of a variety of social, economic, and/or political forces (*e.g., political oppression as a result of colonialist policies, rapid technological change, the movement of First Nations and Inuit youth away from their communities*) on the disruption or continuation of oral traditions in contemporary First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities

Sample questions: “How does transcribing an oral text into writing affect its interpretation? What are the social implications for the transmission of knowledge?”

Culturally Appropriate Listening Practices

B1.4 select and use culturally appropriate listening practices during oral teachings by First Nations, Métis, and Inuit speakers (*e.g., demonstrate respect for the length of time a speaker needs to convey ideas; refrain from writing notes during a telling unless specifically permitted to do so; make personal connections to a teaching by an Elder, Métis Senator, knowledge keeper, or knowledge holder for the purpose of applying the learning to their own circumstances*)

Sample questions: “Why might it be important to hear an oral teaching repeatedly?” “What strategies can you use to remember oral information without taking notes or using recording devices?”

B2. Listening to Understand

By the end of this course, students will:

Purpose

B2.1 identify the purpose of a variety of listening tasks, with a focus on listening to oral texts from and/or related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and set goals for specific tasks (*e.g., to take note of terminology specific to a Métis context in a lecture by a guest speaker; to offer classmates constructive advice as they rehearse their oral presentations; to make a personal connection to a teaching by an Elder, Métis Senator, knowledge keeper, or knowledge holder*)

Sample questions: “What do you hope to learn by listening to this text? How can you ensure that you achieve that goal?”

Using Active Listening Strategies

B2.2 select and use appropriate active listening strategies when interacting in a variety of oral communication contexts related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures (*e.g., pause*

before responding to diverse opinions to moderate reflexive internal reactions during discussions about controversial topics; choose a seating position close to a presenter to remove the possibility of any distractions while listening)

Sample questions: “What stereotypes or biases might be preventing you from listening with an open mind? What are some listening strategies that might help you consider the speaker’s perspective?”

Using Listening Comprehension Strategies

B2.3 select and use appropriate listening comprehension strategies before, during, and after listening to understand oral texts from and/or related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, including increasingly complex texts (*e.g., make connections between the ideas presented and previous knowledge to facilitate their understanding of an Elder’s or Métis Senator’s sharing; note a First Nation, Métis, or Inuk speaker’s preferences about terminology and prepare questions about the appropriate use of these terms; restate key points in a peer conference to confirm their understanding of the information; read the lyrics of a song before listening to it*)

Sample questions: “What listening strategies can you use when the subject matter is unfamiliar?” “How did knowing the expected order of introductory information about name, clan, and nation for speakers from a particular First Nation help you prepare to listen to the presenter’s opening remarks? How might researching cultural expectations about making introductions help you prepare to receive such information more effectively in future?” “How does having some background information about the speaker help you ask appropriately focused questions during a presentation?”

Demonstrating Understanding of Content

B2.4 identify, in a variety of ways, important information and ideas in oral texts from and/or related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, including increasingly complex texts (*e.g., identify recurring themes and structures in two or more oral stories from the same culture; write a summary of the key points in an oral presentation about a current initiative affecting a local First Nation community; cite examples from an oral text to support their personal opinions in a small-group discussion*)

Sample question: “What were some key points the Inuk artist made in his presentation about his career path?”

Interpreting Texts

B2.5 develop and explain interpretations of oral texts from and/or related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, including increasingly complex texts, using evidence from the text, including oral and visual cues, to support their interpretations appropriately (e.g., *identify the specific comedic techniques used by a First Nation stand-up performer and explain how they affect the message of the comedy routine; compare how an Indigenous filmmaker and a non-Indigenous filmmaker use visual cues or visual aids to convey messages, and offer reasons for the differences and similarities*)

Sample questions: “What world view is the actor representing when she speaks with spirit beings in the play? What visual elements influenced your interpretation of this moment in the play?”

Extending Understanding of Texts

B2.6 extend their understanding of oral texts from and/or related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, including increasingly complex texts, by making connections between the ideas in them and in other texts and to their own knowledge, experience, and insights (e.g., *make connections between the themes highlighted in oral accounts of creation from two or more First Nations, Métis, or Inuit groups; explain how personal testimony by residential school survivors and/or intergenerational survivors enriched their understanding of the legacy of the Indian residential school system in Canada and the meaning of reconciliation beyond what they learned from a documentary on the same topic*)

Sample questions: “What insights did you gain from listening to a Cree Elder speak about life in his community that helped you prepare to interview a residential school survivor or intergenerational survivor from the same community effectively? What kinds of connections might you make between the interviewee’s responses and your own knowledge to solidify your understanding of the issue while respecting his or her experience?”

Analysing Texts

B2.7 analyse oral texts from and/or related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, including increasingly complex texts, focusing on the ways in which they communicate information, themes, ideas, and issues and influence the listener’s/viewer’s response (e.g., *compare the conclusions of two speeches to determine how the final message might influence the listener’s response to the whole speech in each case; analyse how a speaker uses statistics to persuade an audience;*

explain how figurative language establishes a particular tone and mood in a television or online commentary on an issue of importance to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities; explain the techniques used in a radio commercial for a First Nations festival to spark listeners’ interest in the event)

Sample questions: “Why do you think the speaker ended with a particular message? How did that influence your response to the whole speech? What other message might the speaker have ended with, and how would that have changed your response to the topic?”

Critical Literacy

B2.8 identify and analyse the perspectives and/or biases evident in oral texts from and/or related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, including increasingly complex texts, and comment on any questions they may raise about beliefs, values, identity, and power (e.g., *compare the perspectives expressed by two or more First Nations leaders in public addresses on nation-to-nation relations and identify the beliefs and values that shape these perspectives; after listening to a radio panel about an issue of importance to Inuit communities and conducting research on the backgrounds of the commentators, suggest reasons for their differences of opinion; identify points that were relevant to a speaker’s argument but were not included in the presentation and suggest reasons for the omission*)

Sample questions: “What personal values did the commentator convey in the current affairs program on environmental protests by First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities?” “In your opinion, what influence does a national news commentator have on the beliefs of Canadians with respect to issues of importance to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals and communities?”

Understanding Presentation Strategies

B2.9 evaluate the effectiveness of a variety of presentation strategies used in oral texts from and/or related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, including increasingly complex texts, and suggest other strategies that could be used effectively (e.g., *compare an audio recording and a video recording of a comic monologue and explain how the performer adjusts the material to suit the format; explain how an Indigenous storyteller uses tone of voice, pauses, and facial expressions to heighten the effect of an oral teaching; evaluate the areas of greater and lesser strength in a peer’s presentation on an aspect of Inuit cultural practice and offer constructive feedback about alternative strategies to use*)

Sample questions: “How did the speaker establish credibility early on in the presentation about the impact of climate change on Inuit cultural practices? Why was it important for the speaker to establish a personal connection to Arctic communities at the beginning of the presentation?”

B3. Speaking to Communicate

By the end of this course, students will:

Purpose

B3.1 orally communicate information and ideas related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures and/or perspectives for a variety of purposes, using language and following social codes appropriate for the intended purpose and audience (e.g., *acknowledge a gift or offering and the context in which it was given before proceeding to speak about an issue they are familiar with; deliver a presentation on art forms produced by a local First Nation, using appropriate terminology; present a dramatic monologue in the character of a historically significant First Nation, Métis, or Inuk individual, using language appropriate to the period*)

Sample questions: “As you prepare to present a monologue from the perspective of this historical Métis figure, what elements of the social, political, and economic context must you keep in mind?” “Who is the intended audience for your presentation on First Nations contemporary art? How might that affect the language you use?”

Interpersonal Speaking Strategies

B3.2 demonstrate an understanding of a variety of interpersonal speaking strategies, and adapt them appropriately to suit the purpose, situation, and audience, exhibiting sensitivity to cultural differences (e.g., *prepare a flexible seminar agenda to facilitate the free flow of ideas; ensure that all participants in a small-group discussion have the opportunity to voice their opinions*)

Sample questions: “How can you acknowledge dissenting voices in a conversation?” “How can you effectively demonstrate respect for diversity during a group discussion about First Nations, Métis, and Inuit stereotypes?”

Clarity and Coherence

B3.3 orally communicate information and ideas related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures and/or perspectives in a clear, coherent manner, using a structure and style appropriate for the purpose, subject matter, and intended audience (e.g., *anticipate gaps in the knowledge of their audience and prepare speaking points to address them; use a logical structure for an informational*

presentation that includes an opening statement, a point-by-point argument, and a conclusion; tailor a speech to make an emotional appeal to a particular audience)

Sample questions: “How can you incorporate a variety of examples to make your oral arguments more effective?” “What data can you use to support the arguments in your presentation?”

Diction and Devices

B3.4 use appropriate words, phrases, and terminology, and a variety of stylistic devices, to communicate information and ideas related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures and/or perspectives and to engage their intended audience (e.g., *use analogies to enhance their spoken messages; choose diction to effectively communicate the ideas they wish to emphasize in a spoken-word performance about reconciliation or Indigenous children's rights in Canada; repeat key points at appropriate moments in an oral presentation to keep their audience focused; use personal anecdotes to engage their audience*)

Sample question: “How might you change your diction to communicate the message of your spoken-word performance more effectively?”

Vocal Strategies

B3.5 identify a variety of vocal strategies, including tone, pace, pitch, and volume, and use them appropriately and with sensitivity to audience needs and cultural differences (e.g., *incorporate deliberate pauses into a speech to enhance the impact of the message and to allow their audience sufficient time to process information; increase their speaking volume to emphasize important points; enunciate technical and unfamiliar words and phrases to ensure that their audience hears them clearly*)

Sample question: “How might you use silence to communicate meaning in an oral presentation?”

Non-Verbal Cues

B3.6 identify a variety of non-verbal cues, including facial expressions, gestures, and eye contact, and use them appropriately and with sensitivity to audience needs and cultural differences to help convey their meaning (e.g., *use culturally acceptable body language and gestures when addressing a diverse audience; use a range of facial expressions to convey different emotions during a presentation*)

Sample question: “What contextual clues might you look for to determine the types of non-verbal communication your audience will consider appropriate?”

Audio-Visual Aids

B3.7 use a variety of audio-visual aids appropriately to support and enhance oral presentations on subject matter related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and to engage their intended audience (*e.g., use presentation software to highlight the key points of a seminar; create a brochure that summarizes key points in an oral presentation on a First Nation poet to enable their audience to focus on the presentation without taking notes*)

Sample questions: “What can a presenter do to ensure that audio-visual material is a support rather than a distraction?” “What culturally specific images might you include in your slideshow? How would they support your message?” “How might links to First Nations, Métis, or Inuit websites enhance your presentation?” “How might the use of graphs help the audience understand your argument?”

B4. Reflecting on Skills and Strategies

By the end of this course, students will:

Metacognition

B4.1 describe a variety of strategies they used before, during, and after listening to and speaking about texts from and/or related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, then explain which ones they found most helpful and identify appropriate steps they can take to improve their oral communication skills (*e.g., plan to monitor audience response during an oral presentation in order to adjust their delivery; plan to*

include visual prompts in their presentations to elicit audience participation that will develop a deeper understanding of the content being presented)

Sample questions: “How does rehearsing a presentation help you respond to questions from the teacher and your peers during the actual presentation?” “What note-taking strategy do you find most effective while you are listening? What makes it effective?”

Interconnected Skills

B4.2 identify a variety of skills they have in reading, writing, viewing, and representing, and explain how these skills help them interpret and discuss oral texts from and/or related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures more effectively (*e.g., describe how viewing television and online video interviews of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit leaders can help them improve the speaking and listening skills they use in debates; explain how a specific writing skill can be used to create an effective audio-visual presentation; explain how understanding their own needs as listeners can help them improve their speaking skills*)

Sample question: “How does observing communication protocols at a community gathering or event prior to speaking help you to address that audience respectfully?”

C. READING AND LITERATURE STUDIES

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1. Reading for Meaning:** read and demonstrate an understanding of a variety of literary, informational, and graphic texts from First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and, as appropriate, relevant texts from non-Indigenous sources, using a range of strategies to construct meaning;
- C2. Understanding Form and Style:** identify a variety of text forms, text features, and stylistic elements in texts from First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and, as appropriate, relevant texts from non-Indigenous sources, and demonstrate an understanding of how they help communicate meaning;
- C3. Reading with Fluency:** use knowledge of words and cueing systems to read fluently;
- C4. Reflecting on Skills and Strategies:** reflect on and identify their strengths as readers, areas for improvement, and the strategies they found most helpful before, during, and after reading texts from First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and, as appropriate, texts from non-Indigenous sources;
- C5. First Nations, Métis, and Inuit Voices in Contemporary Literature:** identify various contributions of individuals, organizations, and initiatives, including technological initiatives, to the development of contemporary First Nations, Métis, and Inuit literature, and analyse the social and cultural influence of those contributions.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

C1. Reading for Meaning

By the end of this course, students will:

Variety of Texts

- C1.1** read a variety of short, contemporary student- and teacher-selected texts from First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and, as appropriate, relevant texts from non-Indigenous sources, identifying specific purposes for reading (*e.g., to prepare for a debate by reading newspaper articles about events that demonstrate the importance of self-determination, sovereignty, and/or self-governance to contemporary First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals and communities; to gather information from several First Nations websites in order to create a chart illustrating the connections between diverse cultures*)

Sample questions: “In what ways do you approach a text differently when reading for pleasure and when reading to gather information for a research project?” “What specific reading tasks might support your preparation for a debate?”

Using Reading Comprehension Strategies

- C1.2** select and use appropriate reading comprehension strategies before, during, and after reading to understand texts from First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and, as appropriate, relevant texts from non-Indigenous sources, including increasingly complex texts (*e.g., plot events in a novel on a timeline and add significant historical events to help them understand the context within which a First Nations, Métis, or Inuit storyline occurs; use a graphic organizer to record details about the characters in a short story and their relationships to one another; preview terminology, particularly as it relates to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities and cultural identity, before reading an informational text about a specific cultural group*)

Sample question: “What historical knowledge can you draw on to develop your understanding of the setting of this story?”

Demonstrating Understanding of Content

- C1.3** identify the most important ideas and supporting details in texts from First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and, as appropriate, in relevant texts from non-Indigenous sources,

including increasingly complex texts (e.g., explain how a scatter graph enhances the reader's understanding of an article about urban and rural Inuit populations; create a concept map illustrating the challenges related to identity that the main character faces in a short story with a Métis protagonist)

Sample question: “What supporting details make the writer’s thesis compelling?”

Making Inferences

C1.4 make and explain inferences about texts from First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and, as appropriate, relevant texts from non-Indigenous sources, including increasingly complex texts, supporting their explanations with well-chosen stated and implied ideas from the texts (e.g., based on its cover, make inferences about the content of an Indigenous print or digital magazine; make inferences about the political values reflected in editorial cartoons about a current issue of importance to First Nations, Métis, or Inuit communities, using a graphic organizer to compare the stated and implied ideas in the cartoons; explain what motivates a character in a short story on the basis of his or her actions)

Sample questions: “What inferences can you make about the cultural identities of the characters in the opening scene of this play? In what specific ways did their conversation convey ideas about First Nations, Métis, or Inuit identity?”

Extending Understanding of Texts

C1.5 extend their understanding of texts from First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and, as appropriate, relevant texts from non-Indigenous sources, including increasingly complex texts, by making appropriate connections between the ideas in them and in other texts and to their own knowledge, experience, and insights (e.g., compare the trickster figure in two or more texts, explain the effect of the trickster’s actions on the moral development of the main character in each case, and identify a “trickster” who has influenced their own behaviour; compare a fictional protagonist’s struggles to conform to social expectations in a short story with similar struggles depicted in a recent film and with their own experience or the experience of their peers; relate Statistics Canada data on employment rates in First Nations communities to what they know about unemployment in their own community)

Sample questions: “How did your experience of your own community affect your understanding of the social context of the play?” “Which of the various traditional stories you recently read in class did you find the greatest personal connection to? Why?”

Analysing Texts

C1.6 analyse texts, including increasingly complex texts, in terms of the information, themes, ideas, and issues they explore in relation to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, explaining how various aspects of the texts contribute to the presentation or development of these elements (e.g., outline the role of the trickster figure in the play and explain the effect of his dual nature on the intended message; analyse how graphs are used to present information in a report about First Nations, Métis, and Inuit small businesses; compare the use of landscape imagery to illustrate the theme of coming of age in two or more First Nations, Métis, or Inuit traditional stories)

Sample questions: “How do the metaphors in this poem help the reader understand the ideas, emotions, and connection to the spirit that it describes?” “What elements of the story emphasize the theme of the interconnectedness of all things?” “What recurring themes emerge in your study of creation stories from various nations?” “In what specific ways does Sophie Pierre née Eustace’s ‘The Little Girl Who Would Be Chief’, a chapter in *Speaking My Truth: Reflections on Reconciliation and Residential School*, promote deeper understanding of the role of women in Indigenous leadership and governance? How does the author use perspective and voice to help explain the context for the truth and reconciliation movement in Canada today?”

Evaluating Texts

C1.7 evaluate the effectiveness of texts from First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and, as appropriate, relevant texts from non-Indigenous sources, including increasingly complex texts, using evidence from the text to support their opinions (e.g., after reading a selection of short stories, explain why the exploration of the theme of identity is more culturally authentic in one particular story than in others; explain how a biography of a well-known Métis figure has deepened their understanding of its subject; compare two reviews of a new release by an Inuk musician and explain what makes one seem more or less reliable than the other)

Sample questions: “How authentically has the author captured the connection between humankind and the natural world?” “What aspects of this poem make it an effective expression of individual and cultural identity? How are these two forms of identity connected?”

Critical Literacy

C1.8 identify and analyse the perspectives and/or biases evident in texts dealing with themes, ideas, and issues related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, including increasingly complex texts, commenting on any questions they may raise about beliefs, values, identity, and power (e.g., *explain how the perspective of a news columnist is revealed in the selection of facts in an article; analyse several issues of a popular print or digital magazine to identify which ethno-cultural groups are under-represented; identify messages about power relations in the lyrics of a popular song; explain how the organization of a letter can imply a power imbalance when the introductory remarks do not contextualize the writer and his or her base of knowledge*)

Sample questions: “What social and legal conditions of the historical period in which this story is set might help you understand the actions and attitudes of the First Nations characters?” “What different political perspectives do the editorials in these two publications present? In your opinion, do the texts represent First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals fairly? Why, or why not?”

C2. Understanding Form and Style

By the end of this course, students will:

Text Forms

C2.1 identify a variety of characteristics of literary, informational, and graphic text forms, and explain how they help communicate meaning or reflect a world view (e.g., *conflict and characterization are used in a short story to convey the world views of the characters; the introductory sentence of a movie review often signals whether the review is positive or negative; information can be organized in a question-and-answer, problem-solution, or cause-and-effect pattern in an article, brochure, or other informational text form*)

Sample questions: “How might the ideas about identity expressed through dialogue in this play be conveyed in a short story? What aspects of meaning would be gained or lost by using the narrative form?” “Why are safety instructions usually presented in a list of steps rather than in prose paragraphs? Why is the order in which the steps are listed important?”

Text Features

C2.2 identify a variety of features of texts from First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and, as appropriate, relevant texts from non-Indigenous sources, and explain how they help communicate

meaning or reflect a world view (e.g., *explain how the subheadings in a magazine article on a First Nations, Métis, or Inuit theme help the reader make connections to the content; identify the non-narrative features of a report on housing in First Nations or Inuit communities and explain how they support the text; explain how the layout of the front page of a First Nation community newspaper draws the reader’s attention to main features*)

Sample questions: “Which features of this magazine article made complex ideas about an issue of importance to Inuit communities more accessible to non-Inuit readers?” “Why did the poet use a different font at this point in the poem? How did that alter the meaning?” “What textual features does the author use to reveal the First Nations, Métis, or Inuit identity of the characters?”

Elements of Style

C2.3 identify a variety of elements of style in texts related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and, as appropriate, in relevant texts from non-Indigenous sources, and explain how they help communicate meaning or reflect a world view and enhance the effectiveness of the text (e.g., *explain how the use of personification to define what a living being is reflects a particular world view in works by First Nations, Métis, and Inuit writers; identify how the use of dialect affects the reader’s interpretation of a character; identify the purpose of rhetorical questions in a report*)

Sample questions: “What information about setting does the dialect of the character in this story convey?” “What is the effect of the rhetorical questions in this section of the report?”

C3. Reading with Fluency

By the end of this course, students will:

Reading Familiar Words

C3.1 demonstrate an automatic understanding of most words in a variety of reading contexts related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures (e.g., *correctly identify terms used in newspapers to refer to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals, communities, and governments; read with understanding words in grade-level texts on topics of importance to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures and terms associated with cooperative education courses and placements; read and correctly define terms used in various tax and budget forms*)

Sample question: “What does the term ‘settlement’ mean when used by Métis communities in reference to their homelands?”

Reading Unfamiliar Words

C3.2 use appropriate decoding strategies to read and understand unfamiliar words in texts from First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and, as appropriate, in relevant texts from non-Indigenous sources (*e.g., use a glossary to decode new words encountered in First Nations, Métis, and Inuit literature; use knowledge of word order and of the relationship between words to guess the meaning of a new word; look for unfamiliar words within familiar words; use knowledge of roots, prefixes, and suffixes to predict meaning*)

Sample questions: “What did you see in this word that helped you connect it to a word you already knew?” “In what context have you seen part of this word within another word? What does that suggest about its meaning in this text?”

Developing Vocabulary

C3.3 identify and use a variety of strategies to expand vocabulary (*e.g., compile a list of specialized vocabulary; use a thesaurus to find synonyms for new words encountered while reading and record them in a reading log*), focusing on words and phrases that have particular significance for First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities (*e.g., citizenship, good life, First Nation community, traditional territory, unceded territory, on reserve, sovereignty, self-governance, ways of knowing*) and explaining the evolving usage of these terms

Sample questions: “What different synonyms might contemporary Indigenous and non-Indigenous readers find for the term ‘homeland’? What synonyms might a person from another historical period assign to this word?” “What contextual clues suggest that the characters in the story understand this term in a way that differs from contemporary understanding?” “Which abstract words in this report could be changed to concrete words to make the meaning clearer? What strategies would you use to identify appropriate synonyms?”

C4. Reflecting on Skills and Strategies

By the end of this course, students will:

Metacognition

C4.1 describe a variety of strategies they used before, during, and after reading texts from and/or related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, explain which ones they found most helpful, and identify appropriate steps they can take to improve as readers (*e.g., create a mind map of strategies, using colours, symbols, or fonts*

to illustrate the usefulness of the strategies and their mastery of them; select one strategy they found helpful when reading complex informational texts and describe how they used it)

Sample questions: “What pre-reading strategy did you use before starting your independent reading of the novel? How did it help you to make sense of the introduction?” “What effect did small-group discussions have on the predictions you made about the story? How might you improve your participation in similar discussions?”

Interconnected Skills

C4.2 identify a variety of skills they have in listening, speaking, writing, viewing, and representing, and explain how these skills help them read texts from and/or related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures more effectively (*e.g., explain how listening to live presentations and radio talks by First Nations, Métis, and Inuit writers can help them analyse the themes of texts they are reading in class; identify specific ways in which writing summaries of reports and other informational texts they read can clarify their understanding of the contents*)

Sample question: “What insight into the text did you gain from listening to the author’s online talk about personal achievements with respect to reclaiming cultural identity and reaching professional goals?”

C5. First Nations, Métis, and Inuit Voices in Contemporary Literature

By the end of this course, students will:

Development of Contemporary Literature

C5.1 identify the contributions of several different individuals, organizations, and initiatives to the development of contemporary First Nations, Métis, and Inuit literature (*e.g., individuals: Richard Wagamese, Drew Hayden Taylor, Rachel Attitug Qitsualik-Tinsley; organizations: publishers with a First Nations, Métis, or Inuit focus; the Canada Council for the Arts and other funding organizations that offer grants to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit writers and storytellers; initiatives: the First Nation Communities Read program, national and regional writing contests, special interest columns in mainstream publications*)

Sample questions: “What is the First Nation Communities Read program? What is its specific contribution to the development of First Nations literature?”

Influence of Contemporary Literature

C5.2 describe several different ways in which contemporary First Nations, Métis, and Inuit literary works contribute to identities and heritage in Canada (e.g., *widening the diversity represented in Indigenous literature in Canada; encouraging non-Indigenous Canadians to embrace First Nations, Métis, and Inuit perspectives as part of reconciliation; allowing First Nations, Métis, and Inuit readers to see their identities reflected in literature by Indigenous writers in Canada*), commenting on the role of literature as a social and cultural force in First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities

Sample questions: “What impact have the works of Leanne Simpson had on the ways non-Indigenous individuals in Canada understand cultural identity? What reasons can you offer for your opinion?”

Influence of Technology

C5.3 identify and describe several different ways in which technology is being used to help promote the work of contemporary First Nations, Métis, and Inuit writers and publishers (e.g., *websites and social media networks allow publishers to promote the works of Indigenous writers; print-on-demand self-publishing sites allow First Nations, Métis, and Inuit writers to distribute their work as their audience grows, without the financial commitment of printing a fixed number of copies in advance; video links make it possible for arts journalists to interview and promote writers who live far from mainstream media studios*)

Sample questions: “Why might First Nations, Métis, and Inuit writers and publishers consider using print-on-demand publishing rather than traditional printing and distribution channels?” “How are First Nations, Métis, and Inuit writers using social media to draw attention to their work as well as to the realities that Indigenous peoples face?”

D. WRITING

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- D1. Developing and Organizing Content:** generate, gather, and organize ideas and information to write for an intended purpose and audience on subject matter related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures;
- D2. Using Knowledge of Form and Style:** draft and revise their writing, using a variety of literary, informational, and graphic forms and stylistic elements appropriate for the purpose and audience;
- D3. Applying Knowledge of Conventions:** use editing, proofreading, and publishing skills and strategies, and knowledge of language conventions, to correct errors, refine expression, and present their work effectively;
- D4. Reflecting on Skills and Strategies:** reflect on and identify their strengths as writers, areas for improvement, and the strategies they found most helpful at different stages of writing texts on subject matter related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

D1. Developing and Organizing Content

By the end of this course, students will:

Identifying Topic, Purpose, and Audience

- D1.1** identify the topic, purpose, and audience for a variety of writing tasks on subject matter related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures (*e.g., an opinion piece for a local magazine expressing a youth's perspective on media portrayals of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals; a responsive text to help someone from a different background better understand the First Nations, Métis, and Inuit attachment to land and place described in various narratives; a review of several websites that provide information about Inuit history, culture, geography, and current events; a speech to a youth forum about an issue of importance to Métis youth*)

Sample questions: “Who are the readers for your essay about the safety and well-being of youth? How might you use an opening scenario to engage them?”

Generating and Developing Ideas

- D1.2** generate, expand, explore, and focus ideas for potential writing tasks, using a variety of strategies and print, electronic, and other resources, as appropriate (*e.g., brainstorm with peers about potential writing topics; research First*

Nations, Métis, and Inuit media channels to identify potential sources of information for an essay about challenges facing contemporary Indigenous families; conduct online keyword searches related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit content before finalizing their topic to see which ones generate the most results; create and use a step-by-step plan to research different perspectives about an issue of importance to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals)

Sample questions: “If the purpose of your paragraph is to emphasize the value of understanding the history and impact of the residential school system in Canada, where will you begin to look for information?” “How might you use oral stories from survivors, Elders, Métis Senators, knowledge holders, knowledge keepers, or community members as a source of information about your topic?”

Research

- D1.3** locate and select information to appropriately support ideas for writing, using a variety of strategies and print, electronic, and other resources, as appropriate (*e.g., compare various resources that portray the cultural diversity of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and seek the perspectives of local Elders, Métis Senators, knowledge holders, knowledge keepers, and/or community members on the accuracy and comprehensiveness of the material they have chosen to support their topic; record all sources of information,*

observing conventions for proper documentation, to ensure that all sources and extracts are fully acknowledged in their final piece of work; before completing their research, conduct a conference with the teacher or teacher-librarian to help them determine whether the sources they have consulted are adequate and the information they have selected is complete, authentic, accurate, and respectful and represents a range of views)

Sample questions: “What resource selection strategies have you developed to guide your search for information about Cree culture and heritage in Ontario?” “What questions could you ask to help expand your research and ensure that the information you find is relevant, authentic, reliable, and up to date?” “What is the most important criterion to consider when authenticating material to support your ideas and citing the material correctly?”

Organizing Ideas

D1.4 identify, sort, and order main ideas and supporting details for writing tasks, using a variety of strategies and organizational patterns suited to the content and the purpose for writing (e.g., use a concept map to organize the ideas, information, and graphics they wish to include in an information sheet about school board initiatives with a First Nations, Métis, and Inuit focus; use a four directions model, informed by teachings from a knowledge holder, to clarify the balance or imbalance between physical, mental, emotional, and spiritual concepts in preparation for writing a spoken-word poem; use a storyboard to order elements chronologically for a short history of a particular First Nation)

Sample questions: “How will you sort the information you have gathered from various sources to use in writing your report on school board initiatives with a First Nations, Métis, or Inuit focus?” “What strategies will best help you make connections between the various pieces of information you have gathered?”

Reviewing Content

D1.5 determine whether the ideas and information gathered are relevant to the topic, accurate, complete, and appropriately meet the requirements of the writing task (e.g., ask a peer knowledgeable in the subject matter to review their article on First Nations, Métis, and Inuit hunting, fishing, and trapping rights and to recommend additional perspectives to include; skim their notes to confirm that the information and ideas address all the specific assignment requirements and to determine if any aspect of the topic is missing)

Sample questions: “Why did you wish to include a personal anecdote in your newspaper article about the negative consequences of racially motivated name calling? How is it relevant to your topic?” “Does your research reflect the diversity of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures?”

D2. Using Knowledge of Form and Style

By the end of this course, students will:

Form

D2.1 write for different purposes and audiences using a variety of literary, informational, and graphic text forms (e.g., a survey comparing the responses of classmates to a short story on the theme of cultural change studied in class; the table of contents for a report on the cultural practices of various First Nations in Ontario in the twenty-first century; an information booklet highlighting the contributions of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals and communities to Canadian society; an informational text explaining a technical procedure; a short article for the school newspaper proposing a solution to an environmental problem)

Sample questions: “What text form will you use to support a public awareness campaign about the treaty or treaties governing the territory in which the school community is located? What makes this form a good choice?”

Voice

D2.2 establish a distinctive voice in their writing, modifying language and tone skilfully to suit the form, audience, and purpose for writing (e.g., write as if speaking to convey sincerity in a letter to a close friend summarizing their thoughts about First Nations experiences in contemporary urban settings; use an authoritative tone in a letter to a school newspaper about the consequences of unsafe drinking water; incorporate expressions frequently used in social media to convey immediacy in a free-verse poem articulating their response to the impact of climate change on the people, environment, and/or economy of the Arctic)

Sample questions: “What tone do you think is suitable for a written account of an incident that will be presented at a consultation with a local First Nation, Métis, or Inuit organization? What specific phrases and sentence structures might you use to establish an appropriate tone?”

Diction

D2.3 use appropriate descriptive and evocative words, phrases, and expressions imaginatively to make their writing clear, vivid, and interesting for their intended audience (*e.g., engage in rapid writing focused on a First Nations, Métis, or Inuit theme, and then select words from the text that will be effective for their specific writing task; underline any words in their writing that are culturally insensitive or stereotypical and replace them with precise, powerful synonyms or antonyms; incorporate words and phrases into their writing that respectfully, accurately, and appropriately emphasize First Nations, Métis, and Inuit perspectives*)

Sample questions: “Do the words your character uses to express emotions at this point in the story ring true? Why, or why not? What synonyms might be more precise or powerful?” “What are some ways in which writers choose diction to ensure that their stories contain authentic Indigenous characters? What examples can you give from the text you are reading?”

Sentence Craft and Fluency

D2.4 write complete sentences that communicate their meaning clearly and accurately, varying sentence type, structure, and length to suit different purposes and making smooth and logical transitions between ideas (*e.g., combine short sentences to add variety to a paragraph or to improve the narrative flow; shorten overly long sentences to hold the reader’s attention*)

Sample question: “How could you combine these two short sentences, which refer to different aspects of the same idea, to make the relationship between these elements clearer to the reader?”

Critical Literacy

D2.5 explain how their own beliefs, values, and experiences are revealed in their writing, and how these may reflect or conflict with a First Nation, Métis, or Inuit world view (*e.g., determine whether a perspective expressed in their writing reflects bias and explain why; write a short script in which two characters express different perspectives on a current issue of concern to a local First Nation community, and explain how these viewpoints reflect or conflict with their own opinion and the opinions expressed by community leaders; ask themselves whether someone from a different background would be able to understand the attachment to an object or place described in their narrative, and adjust the text to help others better understand*)

Sample questions: “In what specific ways do the ideas or attitudes expressed in your text reflect your own beliefs? Are these beliefs

shared by everyone in your community? If not, how might you explain the differences?” “How could you alter your text to help someone with a different background understand your ideas?”

Revision

D2.6 revise drafts to improve the content, organization, clarity, and style of their written work, using a variety of teacher-modelled strategies (*e.g., delete irrelevant arguments to enhance the impact of a persuasive essay; add details to clarify the motivations of a character in a short narrative; reorganize the information in a news report to engage the reader from the beginning; apply the four directions model to determine whether their writing is balanced appropriately for the specific task*)

Sample questions: “Review the supporting details in your persuasive essay. What information might you add in order to convince readers of your viewpoint?” “How might you reorganize your narrative to make the ideas clearer?” “Consider whether your readers will be familiar with the concepts you mention in your news report. Which ones need to be explained more fully?” “In what ways does your writing align with or diverge from the four directions model?”

Producing Drafts

D2.7 produce revised drafts of texts, including increasingly complex texts, written to meet criteria identified by the teacher, based on the curriculum expectations and respecting First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communication styles (*e.g., adequate development of information and ideas, logical organization, appropriate use of form and style, appropriate use of conventions*)

Sample questions: “Ask a peer who is unfamiliar with your topic to read your report. What important aspects did he or she find difficult to understand? How might you develop your ideas more fully?”

D3. Applying Knowledge of Conventions

By the end of this course, students will:

Spelling

D3.1 use knowledge of spelling rules and patterns, a variety of resources, and appropriate strategies to recognize and correct their own and others’ spelling errors (*e.g., apply their knowledge of spelling rules and patterns correctly, such as when adding a suffix to a word ending in a y or a silent e and when considering whether to double the final consonant before a suffix; maintain a list showing the correct spelling of words they frequently*

misspell, and consult it when writing; use their knowledge of root words, prefixes, and suffixes to spell unfamiliar words correctly)

Sample questions: “Which English spelling patterns give you trouble? How might you organize a personal spelling reference list to help you apply these patterns correctly?”

Vocabulary

D3.2 build vocabulary for writing by confirming word meaning(s) and reviewing and refining word choice, using a variety of resources and strategies, as appropriate for the purpose (e.g., use a thesaurus to find a more precise word to suit the context, and record the results of their search in a writing log; create and maintain lists of subject-specific and technical terms, and consult these lists to enhance their writing; accurately and respectfully incorporate language associated with First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures into their formal writing)

Sample questions: “Why is it important to consult local resources and/or speakers of an Indigenous language before using terms associated with a specific First Nations, Métis, or Inuit cultural group in your writing?” “Which Indigenous cultural terms might you include in a glossary to support your writing in English?”

Punctuation

D3.3 use punctuation correctly and appropriately to communicate their intended meaning (e.g., use semicolons correctly in compound sentences; use the appropriate punctuation to introduce a list of items)

Sample questions: “Which punctuation mark would signal to readers that you are introducing a list – for example, a list of helpful sources of information about Métis culture?” “What kind of information might you put within parentheses in a sentence? What kind of information in a sentence does *not* belong in parentheses?”

Grammar

D3.4 use grammar conventions correctly and appropriately to communicate their intended meaning clearly and fluently (e.g., use a variety of sentence types correctly in their writing; use prepositions and conjunctions correctly and appropriately; apply correct verb tenses in an essay that outlines the historical background of contemporary events; ensure that their sentences demonstrate parallelism)

Sample questions: “When you read this sentence aloud, does it sound awkward or do you think it flows smoothly? If it seems awkward, how might you fix it? How does your revision alter the grammar?”

Proofreading

D3.5 regularly proofread and correct their writing, using guidelines developed with the teacher and peers (e.g., review drafts using an editing checklist based on the task rubric and/or the four directions concept model; read drafts aloud to identify and correct errors; refer to appropriate sources to determine whether they have correctly used terminology related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures)

Sample questions: “Why do you think it is easier to find errors in someone else’s writing than in your own? What strategy might you use to address that difficulty?”

Publishing

D3.6 use a variety of presentation features, including print and script, fonts, graphics, and layout, to improve the clarity and coherence of their written work and to heighten its appeal for their audience (e.g., select an appealing title and appropriate fonts and graphics for the cover of a booklet they are publishing; use design features such as sufficient white space and clearly labelled diagrams to enhance a fact sheet about a social issue of importance to a First Nation, Métis, or Inuit community)

Sample questions: “What impression would you like your book cover to give prospective readers? Which font is most likely to help convey that impression?”

Producing Finished Works

D3.7 produce pieces of published work to meet criteria identified by the teacher, based on the curriculum expectations and respecting First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communication styles (e.g., adequate development of information and ideas, logical organization, appropriate use of form and style)

Sample questions: “Review your written description of a procedure. Are the steps introduced in logical order? Are any steps missing? How might you make the procedure easier to follow?”

D4. Reflecting on Skills and Strategies

By the end of this course, students will:

Metacognition

D4.1 describe a variety of strategies they used before, during, and after writing texts on subject matter related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, explain which ones they found most helpful, and identify appropriate steps they can take to improve as writers (e.g., describe their use

of one or more graphic organizers to order their ideas at the drafting stage of a writing task; explain how informally conferring with the teacher or peers at various stages of the writing process allowed them to see and correct specific problems; describe a specific area in which they think their writing skills need strengthening and set a time-limited goal for making improvements)

Sample questions: “What do you do to prepare for a writing conference with the teacher?” “What have you realized about your own written work by reading the work of your peers?” “If you were to redo this writing assignment, what specific strategies would you use to improve your work?”

Interconnected Skills

D4.2 identify a variety of skills they have in listening, speaking, reading, viewing, and representing, and explain how these skills help them write texts on subject matter related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures more effectively (e.g., describe specific ways in which listening to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit spoken-word artists has improved their ability to write realistic dialogue; identify some ways in which they apply their persuasive speaking skills to their persuasive writing)

Sample questions: “What have you noticed about the way advertisers use language that you could apply to your persuasive writing?” “How has the work of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit authors, storytellers, poets and spoken-word artists, musicians, and new media artists influenced your writing?”

Portfolio

D4.3 select examples of a variety of types of writing that they think most clearly reflect their growth and competence as writers, and explain the reasons for their choice (e.g., select a finished piece of their writing for a class project on the impact of the Indian residential school system and the Truth and Reconciliation Commission of Canada and explain why they think it is a good example of their work; explain why they find certain text forms more natural or appealing to use than others and identify how these preferences affect their growth as writers)

Sample questions: “Which pieces of writing best demonstrate your improvement as a writer? Why did you choose these pieces?” “In what specific areas has your writing improved?” “In what ways have you developed your understanding of what a cultural text form is? How has this affected your writing?”

E. MEDIA STUDIES

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- E1. Understanding Media Texts:** demonstrate an understanding of a variety of media texts from First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and, as appropriate, relevant media texts from non-Indigenous sources;
- E2. Understanding Media Forms, Conventions, and Techniques:** identify some media forms and explain how the conventions and techniques associated with them are used to create meaning in the context of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures;
- E3. Creating Media Texts:** create a variety of media texts on subject matter related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, for different purposes and audiences, using appropriate forms, conventions, and techniques;
- E4. Reflecting on Skills and Strategies:** reflect on and identify their strengths as interpreters and creators of media texts, areas for improvement, and the strategies they found most helpful in understanding and creating media texts on subject matter related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures;
- E5. First Nations, Métis, and Inuit Voices in Contemporary Media:** identify various contributions of individuals, organizations, and initiatives, including technological initiatives, to the development of contemporary First Nations, Métis, and Inuit media production, analysing the social and cultural influence of those contributions and the role of media literacy.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

E1. Understanding Media Texts

By the end of this course, students will:

Purpose and Audience

- E1.1** explain how media texts from First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and, as appropriate, relevant media texts from non-Indigenous sources including increasingly complex texts, are created to suit particular purposes and audiences (*e.g., explain the purpose of showing a variety of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit role models in urban and rural community settings on reality television programs with an Indigenous target audience; explain the purpose of inviting experts with a spectrum of opinions to speak about issues of importance to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities on mainstream news programs*)

Sample questions: “Who is the audience for this reality television show? What evidence can you offer?” “How might you revise promotional material for a television or web program with primarily First Nations, Métis, or Inuit content in order to increase the number of non-Indigenous viewers?”

Interpreting Messages

- E1.2** interpret media texts from First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and, as appropriate, relevant media texts from non-Indigenous sources, including increasingly complex texts, identifying and explaining the overt and implied messages they convey (*e.g., identify the overt and implied messages about First Nations youth conveyed in a documentary about youth entrepreneurship and suggest reasons for any contradictions between these messages; explain the implied message of an advertising campaign featuring First Nations, Métis, or Inuit imagery*)

Sample questions: “What message is conveyed by the use of an Inuit symbol in this advertising campaign? Why might its use be considered cultural appropriation or offensive?”

Evaluating Texts

- E1.3** evaluate how effectively information, themes, ideas, issues, and opinions are communicated in media texts from First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and, as appropriate, in relevant media texts from non-Indigenous

sources, including increasingly complex texts, and decide whether the texts achieve their intended purpose (e.g., *determine the credibility of a website based on an evaluation of the various voices it incorporates; explain why social media are effective or ineffective channels for communicating First Nations, Métis, and Inuit community news*)

Sample question: “How effectively does the inclusion of multiple first-hand accounts of living in the same Indian residential school support the documentary’s key findings?”

Audience Responses

E1.4 explain why the same media text might prompt different responses from different audiences (e.g., *explain why a Métis leader and a non-Indigenous elected politician might respond differently to a news report on changes to legislation regulating traditional harvesting rights; explain why sports fans might have a variety of responses to a team name, mascot, and/or logo embodying an Indigenous stereotype*)

Sample questions: “In your opinion, why has this documentary on treaty rights and obligations prompted widely conflicting responses among viewers? What specific information may have sparked the polarized reactions?”

Critical Literacy

E1.5 identify the perspectives and/or biases evident in media texts from First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and, as appropriate, in relevant media texts from non-Indigenous sources, including increasingly complex texts, and comment on any questions they may raise about beliefs, values, identity, and power (e.g., *identify issues of individual identity and power raised by the representation of First Nations, Métis, and/or Inuit women on an Indigenous organization’s website; explain how the perspective of a news program is revealed in its choice of experts to discuss an issue of importance to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities; describe how First Nations individuals were portrayed in Wild West shows in the late nineteenth century, and assess the influence of these portrayals on popular beliefs about Indigenous identity*)

Sample questions: “What topics covered by First Nations, Métis, and Inuit news outlets are under-reported in mainstream news media?” “How does the use of the term ‘settler Canadian’ in an advertisement for a webinar on Indigenous peoples in Canada imply a particular historical perspective? What values does the use of this term imply? What does the term suggest about cultural identity?”

Production Perspectives

E1.6 explain how a variety of production, marketing, and distribution factors influence the First Nations, Métis, and Inuit media industry (e.g., *identify some challenges that First Nations, Métis, and Inuit media producers face in gaining access to conventional marketing channels, and describe some recent attempts to address those challenges; explain how product placement works, what the benefits are for the product manufacturer and the media producer, and what First Nations, Métis, and Inuit media producers are doing to secure this form of marketing partnership; suggest reasons why a college with a predominantly Indigenous student population might supplement its course information with promotional materials about the college culture and extra-curricular programs*)

Sample question: “What factors might influence the number of visits that a promotional website for a First Nations, Métis, or Inuit video receives?”

E2. Understanding Media Forms, Conventions, and Techniques

By the end of this course, students will:

Form

E2.1 identify general and specific characteristics of a variety of media forms and explain how they shape content and create meaning in the context of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures (e.g., *social media feeds function in real time to disseminate comments from a broad spectrum of people, allowing First Nations, Métis, and Inuit scholars and journalists to engage an audience of non-scholars as they debate and support one another’s opinions; online cultural performance spaces include digital interactivity to enable First Nations, Métis, and Inuit artists to upload and share their work*)

Sample questions: “Which characteristics of this video about Inuit history indicate that it was made as an educational resource for classrooms rather than as a movie for general release?” “What aspects of this program tell you that you are watching a drama rather than a documentary?”

Conventions and Techniques

E2.2 identify conventions and/or techniques used in a variety of media forms and explain how they convey meaning and influence their audience in the context of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures (e.g., *the inclusion of text translated into syllabics on a playbill advertising an Inuit-related play encourages an Inuit audience*)

to attend; having interview subjects address the camera directly creates a sense of immediacy in a public awareness campaign about a community health or safety issue)

Sample question: “How might having those personally affected by a community health or safety issue address the camera directly influence viewers of a televised public service campaign?”

E3. Creating Media Texts

By the end of this course, students will:

Purpose and Audience

E3.1 describe the topic, purpose, and audience for media texts they plan to create on subject matter related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures (e.g., a blog for their peers explaining insights they gained in a class about First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities in Canada and commenting on why they were unfamiliar with the information and ideas prior to the lesson), and identify some significant challenges they may face in achieving their purpose (e.g., summarizing information concisely and clearly for an audience that is unfamiliar with the topic, finding appropriate channels to promote their blog to its target audience, presenting historical events for which no photographs or video clips exist)

Sample questions: “Who do you want to address in your blog on First Nations, Métis, and Inuit histories? What insights might your intended audience find most interesting? Is there a specific view you wish to promote, or should you present a variety of perspectives?” “What challenges do you face in presenting information about historical events that occurred before the widespread use of photography and sound recording?”

Form

E3.2 select a media form to suit the topic, purpose, and audience for a media text they plan to create on subject matter related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and explain why it is a highly appropriate choice (e.g., explain why an online invitation to an upcoming Indigenous speaker series is an effective way to raise the cultural awareness of their peers; explain which elements of a multimedia text make it an effective form to promote the work of Inuit artists)

Sample question: “Why might an online calendar highlighting the dates of community events be an appropriate way to promote local heritage?”

Conventions and Techniques

E3.3 identify a variety of conventions and/or techniques appropriate to a media form they plan to use, and explain how these will help communicate specific aspects of their intended meaning (e.g., embedding a video clip with a call to action in a presentation about the environment will help audience members make a personal connection to the material by conveying a sense of urgency; adding cultural music to a photo presentation about a Métis settlement will emphasize the rich musical heritage of the community)

Sample questions: “What techniques might you use to make your blog about traditional Indigenous cuisine appealing? What key information might a virtual menu include, for example? How might you use this technique to encourage your audience to read the entire blog?”

Producing Media Texts

E3.4 produce media texts on subject matter related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, for a variety of purposes and audiences, using appropriate forms, conventions, and techniques (e.g., a multimedia presentation on current North American clothing trends inspired by First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, using a voiceover to discuss the line between appreciation and appropriation; an infographic on the changing use of sports mascots that employ First Nations imagery; a video demonstrating how to prepare traditional Métis dishes; a photo essay depicting human connections to the natural environment)

Sample question: “What type of media text would you create to voice your opinion directly to politicians on an issue of importance to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals?”

E4. Reflecting on Skills and Strategies

By the end of this course, students will:

Metacognition

E4.1 describe a variety of strategies they used in interpreting and creating media texts on subject matter related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, explain which ones they found most helpful, and identify appropriate steps they can take to improve as media interpreters and producers (e.g., describe the strategies they used to present a viewpoint persuasively in a media text, identify which were the most effective, and plan to use them in future projects; plan to view a media text multiple times to develop a deeper understanding of its structure and meaning)

Sample questions: “What process did you use to select an appropriate soundtrack for your media text showcasing Inuit musicians? What might you do differently next time?”

Interconnected Skills

E4.2 identify a variety of skills they have in listening, speaking, reading, and writing, and explain how these skills help them interpret and create media texts on subject matter related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures more effectively (e.g., *describe how their skill in scanning Internet resources for specific content can help them prepare an effective presentation on access to mainstream media for First Nations, Métis, and Inuit media creators in the twenty-first century; explain how writing an outline can help them produce a short video*)

Sample question: “How did the listening skills you drew on while participating in a First Nation, Métis, or Inuit community event prepare you for a debate on the needs of Indigenous residents in large urban centres?”

E5. First Nations, Métis, and Inuit Voices in Contemporary Media

By the end of this course, students will:

Media Development

E5.1 identify the contributions of several different individuals, organizations, and initiatives to the development and production of contemporary First Nations, Métis, and Inuit media texts (e.g., individuals: *Alanis Obomsawin, Paul Qulitalik, Tracey Deer*; organizations: *the Alliance of Aboriginal Media Professionals, CBC News Indigenous, Igloodik Isuma Productions*; initiatives: *Muskrat Magazine, Wawatay News*)

Sample questions: “How have Indigenous film festivals in Canada brought attention to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit voices in the media industry? What festivals can you name?” “Which specific college programs can you identify that focus on First Nations, Métis, and Inuit visual and media arts?”

Influence of Media Production

E5.2 describe several different ways in which contemporary First Nations, Métis, and Inuit media texts contribute to heritage and identities in Canada (e.g., *encouraging diverse interpretations of identities in Canada; promoting understanding and acceptance of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit perspectives on issues of importance to Indigenous individuals and communities*), commenting on the role of media production as a social and cultural force in First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities

Sample questions: “What are some stories that First Nations, Métis, and Inuit media creators are choosing to tell in the twenty-first century? How similar or different are they from those produced in the late twentieth century? What influence do those stories have on identities in Canada?”

Media Literacy and Media Access

E5.3 explain the role of media literacy, media access, and technology in supporting contemporary First Nations, Métis, and Inuit media creation and consumption (e.g., *explain how improving media literacy for First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals helps broaden media access in rural and remote communities generally; identify some specific ways in which young First Nations, Métis, and Inuit media creators are using social media and/or demonstrating media literacy; describe some ways in which media technologies are being used to connect First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities with the global community*)

Sample questions: “In what specific ways is media literacy related to the ability of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit videographers to get their product into mainstream channels?” “How are advances in communications technology expanding business opportunities in First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities?”

Appendix to the English Courses

CULTURAL TEXT FORMS

Cultural text forms serve an important purpose in First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, in that they are used to express and communicate a culture's beliefs and values. Their function and purpose distinguish them from purely artistic creations, though they often have aesthetic qualities as well. They may be elements of material culture, including tangible objects; stories; songs, music, or dances; or cultural practices, including those associated with food or medicines. Some examples of cultural text forms and their significance follow:

- traditional clothing, which often expresses the cultural, spiritual, social, and/or political identities of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities
- songs and music, including the practices of drum keepers and dancers (often delineated by gender), used to transmit Indigenous knowledge
- prayers, often expressing belief in the power of spirit to heal
- addresses, affirmations, and orations, illustrating the significance of spoken text
- fire lighting and the burning of sacred medicines to cleanse and purify and/or to communicate with spirit beings
- symbolism embodied in material life to reflect kinship ties, family histories, land agreements, business partnerships, spiritual life, and so on
- oral and written stories used to record and communicate stories of origin, family histories and histories of nations, and relationships to land, spirit, and creation
- languages themselves, which embody and reflect beliefs, values, and significant relationships between humankind and creation

Every culture has a distinct way of creating, passing on, using, and showing respect for its cultural text forms. Some cultural text forms are protected, according to Indigenous traditions. It is therefore critical for educators to understand that it may be necessary for them to engage with and seek direction from the specific Indigenous community from which a cultural text form originates before using it in a classroom setting.

Some cultural text forms, such as prayer, song, and music, are found across First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, while others are unique to particular groups. The chart that follows provides examples of the cultural text forms used by particular cultural groups. It highlights some of the rich forms of communication among Indigenous societies of the oral tradition in Canada.

Cultural Group	Example of Cultural Text Form	Meaning/Purpose	Mode of Communication
Blackfeet	Winter counts	Pictorial calendars or histories drawn on buffalo hides, with a representation of a significant event for each year.	To be viewed, read, and presented
Anishinaabe Ojibwe	Water song	A song sung by women, as the water keepers, to show respect and reverence for the spirit of water, in recognition of its sacredness and its immense importance to all of creation.	To be listened to
Anishinaabe, Haudenosaunee, and other First Nations	Covenant Chain Belt of 1764	A wampum belt displaying symbols made from shells, beads, and string that records the agreement made at Niagara between the British and several First Nations.	To be viewed and read
Haudenosaunee	Thanksgiving address	Words spoken at the beginning of ceremonies and significant meetings to give thanks to the natural environment.	To be listened to
Haudenosaunee	Guswenta or Kaswentha (Two Row Wampum)	A wampum belt displaying symbols made from shells and string that records an agreement between the Haudenosaunee and the Dutch in the mid-seventeenth century. Each row represents a nation, with the belt showing the nations co-existing without interfering in each other's affairs.	To be viewed and read
Métis	Beaded clothing	Items of clothing decorated with detailed beadwork, often in distinctive floral designs. Colours and patterns may convey aspects of Métis history, Métis teachings, and/or family identity.	To be viewed

Cultural Group	Example of Cultural Text Form	Meaning/Purpose	Mode of Communication
Inuit/Inuvialuit	Drum dance	A combination of drumming and dance, traditionally performed by men. Drum dances may be used as a peaceful way to settle disputes.	To be listened to, viewed, and presented
Tsimshian	Button blanket	A robe decorated with white buttons forming images of an animal that represent the clan of the individual wearing the blanket.	To be viewed, read, and presented
Tsimshian	Dances such as the raven dance and the killer whale dance	Dances that communicate important stories about history and creation. Families and/or clans collect and protect these dances, which are passed from one generation to the next.	To be presented and viewed